

TB-2 so far... and the Summative Exam

COMS10015

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2025-26

Summative Exam

Remember the handout

Material: TB1

Week	Type	Date	Content	Assessment
1 to 12			[organisation notation revision questions and solutions]	
1	Lecture slot (synchronous)	16/09/24 QB-1.40 (Pugsley)	Unit and TB-1 intro. [slides notes]	
	Lecture slot (synchronous)	16/09/24 ARTS-B.H05	Boolean algebra [slides notes extended notes] [handout]	
	Lecture slot (synchronous)	17/09/24 ARTS-B.H05	Boolean algebra [slides notes extended notes] [handout]	
	Lab. slot (synchronous)	20/09/24 MVB-2.11 and MVB-1.15	[question solution]	
	Additional resources		• Wikipedia: Boolean algebra	

COMS10015 exam

All questions are **Short Answer** questions.

- ▶ Various forms. Important to *read the question*.
- ▶ Each question is worth a different number of marks. Important to *read the question*.
- ▶ Write your answers in the booklet answer booklet, not the question paper.
- ▶ Examples: answer plus justification, numerical result plus working, 2-3 sentence description, give an example, etc.

Particulars

Closed book The use of external resources (e.g., notes) are **not permitted**.

Calculators Non-programmable calculators **are allowed**. It must comply with Faculty regulations.

Standard duration 2 hours.

Date and time See Examination Timetable from Exams Office.

Location In person, see Examination timetable from Exams Office.

Examinable material

- ▶ All material from the lectures (in TB-1 and TB-2) should be considered examinable.
- ▶ Any other material (e.g., from the lab. slots) can be considered non-examinable.
 - ▶ But, there might be questions about a *technique* you would have used for and therefore understood as a result of engaging with the labs.
- ▶ Expect roughly $\frac{1}{3}$ of exam on TB-1 material, $\frac{2}{3}$ exam on TB-2 material.
- ▶ Exam is worth 70% of the unit:
 - ▶ Final mark for unit will be combination of marks from coursework and exam.

More details in the COMS10015 Organisation handout from Week 1.

Sample questions I

- ▶ Revision questions:
 - ▶ See Unit Web Page.
 - ▶ Large bank of revision questions: one set for each teaching block.
 - ▶ Many adapted from previous exams.
 - ▶ Solutions also provided.
- ▶ Past paper:
 - ▶ See Unit Webpage for past paper exam and solutions.
 - ▶ Past paper indicative of the exam this year.
 - ▶ Some details may have changed in how the material, and what material, was covered this year.

Sample questions II

- ▶ Formative exams:
 - ▶ 4 formative exams (questions and solutions).
 - ▶ Third will be set in Week 18.
 - ▶ Fourth will be set in Week 24.
 - ▶ Do use these as further question material for your revision.
- ▶ Exam advice:
 - ▶ See Unit Webpage for exam advice document.
 - ▶ Clearly outlines how approach answering the questions.

- ▶ Remember you **read** a degree.
- ▶ You have had at least 3+ hours each week to read around the subject.
- ▶ Consult the Further Reading listed at end of each lecture.
- ▶ Useful text book:
 - ▶ Computer Organization and Design: The Hardware/Software Interface, David A. Patterson and John L. Hennessy. QA76.9.C643 PAT,
<https://bris.on.worldcat.org/oclc/1237754847> (book plus online appendices)

TB-2 Part I

TB-2 Part I

- ▶ Instruction Set Architectures
 - ▶ Instruction Classes, Instruction Encoding, Addressing Modes, Examples
- ▶ Micro-architecture
 - ▶ ALU, Control (micro-programs), Buses, Pipelining, Memory hierarchy
- ▶ Hands on experience implementing an ISA (Hex 8)